

North Dakota

The state bird of North Dakota is the western meadowlark.



Wild prairie roses



The different traditions of North Dakota's people weave together a beautiful quilt of cultures. Across the state, powwows celebrate Indigenous history, while special festivals keep Scandinavian customs alive. The people of North Dakota also proudly work to protect the state's wild bison population.

Dakota comes from the Sioux language. It means "friend" or "ally."

Grassy plains in North Dakota

Bison

North Dakota's wild bison were very important to the region's Indigenous peoples—such as the Lakota and Dakota—since they provided food and materials. The animals were nearly hunted to extinction by white settlers, but now many wild bison roam the land again.

